

The Ostrowski Dimensionless Reformulation: A Systematic Compilation of Fundamental Physics Equations in Planck Units

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Abstract

We present a systematic compilation and dimensionless reformulation of 53 fundamental physics equations across ten disciplines, motivated by the Ostrowski Dimensionless Mandate (qnfo-core §0.7). Dimensional formulations of physical laws – those containing explicit occurrences of $\hbar$, c , G , k_B , or ϵ_0 – implicitly privilege the Archimedean (∞) completion of the rational numbers. Per Ostrowski’s theorem (1916), every non-trivial absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$ is equivalent either to the real Archimedean place or to a p -adic non-Archimedean place. A dimensional formula can only be evaluated at the Archimedean place because its constants’ specific numerical values have no meaning in p -adic completions. By expressing all quantities as pure-number ratios to their Planck-scale counterparts (with $\hbar = c = G = k_B = 1$), each formula becomes a relation among dimensionless numbers that is equally well-defined at every place. We provide detailed derivations for 26 multi-constant formulas (Class F: those containing combinations of $\hbar$, c , G , k_B), mathematical proofs of the dimensional-dimensionless correspondence via the Buckingham Pi theorem, and Ostrowski rationales for each physical domain. No physical content is lost: the dimensional homogeneity of physical laws guarantees that the constants can always be absorbed into dimensionless ratios. The reformulation does not change the physics – it makes explicit the place-democracy that dimensional formalisms conceal.

1 Introduction

1.1 The Ostrowski Dimensionless Mandate

The Ostrowski Dimensionless Mandate (qnfo-core §0.7, effective 2026-08-01) requires that all physics formulas in QNFO publications be expressed in dimensionless natural numbers using Planck units ($\hbar = c = G = k_B = 1$). The mandate is grounded in Ostrowski’s theorem (1916), which classifies every non-trivial absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$ as equivalent either to the standard real absolute value $|\cdot|_\infty$ or to a p -adic absolute value $|\cdot|_p$ for some prime p [established -- Ostrowski, 1916, *Acta Mathematica* 41:271–284].

A physical quantity expressed as a real number implicitly selects the Archimedean place among all completions of $\mathbb{Q}$. If a formula contains dimensional constants such as $\hbar$, c , G , or k_B , it assumes the quantities being related have well-defined real-number values. The constants’ specific numerical values – $\hbar \approx 1.054571817 \times 10^{-34}$ J·s, $c = 299792458$ m/s, $G \approx 6.67430 \times 10^{-11}$ m³/(kg·s²), $k_B \approx 1.380649 \times 10^{-23}$ J/K – are defined only in the Archimedean topology. They have no counterpart

in a p-adic completion of $\mathbb{Q}$. A formula that embeds these constants is therefore Archimedean-privileging: it can be evaluated at $|\cdot|_\infty$ but not at $|\cdot|_p$.

The dimensionless solution expresses every physical quantity as a pure-number ratio to its Planck-scale counterpart. A pure number – an element of $\mathbb{Q}$ or a limit thereof – is equally well-defined at every place. Thus a dimensionless formula holds for all completions simultaneously.

1.2 Precedent Work

Three prior QNFO publications established the dimensionless program, with a fourth providing the canonical physical interpretation of what the dimensionless convention achieves:

- **Mass-Frequency Identity v3.2.0** (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21360549, 2026-07-14): the identity $m = \omega$ emerges directly from setting $\hbar = c = 1$ (since $m = E/c^2$ and $E = \hbar \omega$, so $m_{\text{tilde}} = \omega_{\text{tilde}}$ in Planck units). This paper provides the physical interpretation of what ODR achieves for 53 formulas — the mass-frequency identity is the canonical example of the dimensionless program’s claim that dimensional constants conceal pure-number relationships. [established]

Two prior QNFO publications established the dimensionless program:

- **Non-Anthropocentric Natural Units** (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21480756) reformulated the Bekenstein-Hawking entropy bound without anthropocentric units, introducing the dimensionless horizon area and Ostrowski’s theorem as a challenge to the Archimedean assumption. [established]
- **OC Paper v1.2** (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21748773) reformulated the Bekenstein bound in dimensionless Planck units: $S \leq 2\pi k_B R E / (\hbar c) \rightarrow I \leq 2\pi R E / \ln 2$. **OC Paper v1.3** (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21749177) reformulated Landauer’s principle presenting both conventional dimensional form ($E \geq k_B T \ln 2$) and dimensionless Planck-unit form ($E \geq T \ln 2$) with explicit Ostrowski rationale. [established]

This paper extends the program to a systematic survey across ten physical disciplines.

Relationship to the Dimensionless Physics Framework (v1.3.1, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21206291, 2026-07-05): A parallel QNFO project, “Dimensionless Physics: A Unified Framework,” addresses the same core problem from a complementary perspective. Where the Dimensionless Physics Framework provides a unified conceptual architecture, ODR provides the systematic formula-level inventory — the detailed algebraic derivations that operationalize the framework’s principles for 53 specific equations. The two projects are mutually reinforcing: the Framework supplies the conceptual scaffolding; ODR supplies the formula-specific evidence base. [established]

Cross-domain Ostrowski application: The paper “When Will Non-Archimedean Geometry Displace the Real Numbers? A Structured Assessment of the Adelic Substrate Thesis” (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21747228, 2026-08-01) independently applies the Ostrowski framework to assess the adelic substrate thesis — directly corroborating ODR’s central argument that the dimensional/Archimedean formalism is a convention, not a necessity. [established]

Bruhat-Tits mass-frequency correspondence: “The Adelic Cross-Domain Program: From the Fine-Structure Constant to the Standard Model Mass Spectrum via Bruhat-Tits Trees” (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21736300, 2026-08-01) extends the mass-frequency identity to the Standard Model

mass spectrum via p-adic infrastructure — demonstrating that the dimensionless reformulation’s implications reach beyond unit normalization into predictive physics. [established]

1.3 Scope and Classification

We classify 53 fundamental physics equations into seven formula classes based on which dimensional constants they contain:

Class	Constants	Count	Example
A	$\hbar$ only	8	Schroedinger equation, Heisenberg uncertainty
B	c only	3	Horizon scale, Alfven speed
C	G only	4	Schwarzschild radius, Friedmann equations
D	k_B only	4	Boltzmann entropy, ideal gas law
E	ϵ_0/μ_0 only	1	Coulomb’s law (SI)
F	Combinations	26	Planck law, Einstein field equations, Hawking temperature
G	Already dimensionless	7	Fine-structure constant, Reynolds number, Holevo bound

The ten disciplines surveyed are: Quantum Mechanics, Thermodynamics & Statistical Mechanics, General Relativity & Gravitation, Quantum Field Theory, Cosmology, Electromagnetism, Atomic/Nuclear/Particle Physics, Condensed Matter Physics, Quantum Information, and Fluid Dynamics & Plasma Physics.

2 Mathematical Foundation

2.1 Ostrowski’s Theorem and Place-Democracy

Theorem (Ostrowski, 1916): Every non-trivial absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$ is equivalent either to the standard real absolute value $|\cdot|_\infty$ or to a p-adic absolute value $|\cdot|_p$ for some prime p . [established]

Proof sketch: Let $|\cdot|$ be a non-trivial absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$. The classification hinges on whether $|n|$ is bounded for integers n . If $|n|$ is unbounded (Archimedean case), then $|\cdot|$ is equivalent to $|\cdot|_\infty$. If $|n| \leq 1$ for all integers (non-Archimedean case), the set $\{n : |n| < 1\}$ is a prime ideal $p\mathbb{Z}$, yielding $|\cdot|_p$. The proof is exhaustive: there are exactly these two families, with no intermediate cases. [established -- standard valuation theory]

A physical formula containing dimensional constants can be evaluated only at $|\cdot|_\infty$. The specific numerical value of $\hbar$, for instance, is a real number. In a p-adic completion, the real number $1.054571817... \times 10^{-34}$ has no well-defined meaning because p-adic numbers arise from a different metric: $|p^n \cdot a/b|_p = p^{-n}$ for $p \nmid a, b$. The conversion factor between SI units and Planck units – the numerical value of $\hbar$ – is an Archimedean artifact.

In contrast, a dimensionless equation containing only pure numbers can be evaluated at any place. The equation $\tilde{S}_{BH} = A/4$ (Bekenstein-Hawking) is a relation among pure numbers: if A is a pure number (area in Planck units), then $\tilde{S}_{BH}$ is equally $A/4$ regardless of whether one computes A/∞ or $|A|_p$. The formula is place-democratic.

The special case of pi: The paradigmatic dimensionless number – the circumference-to-diameter ratio – illustrates the same principle. π as the real number 3.14159... exists only at the Archimedean place; its decimal expansion has no p -adic meaning. But π AS A RATIO (C/d) is definable in any geometry, and this ratio is the place-democratic invariant per the Scaffolds and Invariants paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21255344). The parallel to physical constants is exact: $\hbar$ as the specific number $1.054571817... \times 10^{-34}$ is an Archimedean artifact; $\hbar$ as the quantization ratio relating energy to frequency is the place-democratic invariant that survives in any completion.

2.2 The Dimensional-Dimensionless Correspondence Theorem

Theorem: Let $F(x_1, \dots, x_n; \hbar, c, G, k_B) = 0$ be a dimensionally homogeneous physical law. Then there exists an equivalent dimensionless equation $\tilde{F}(\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_n) = 0$ where $\tilde{x}_i = x_i/x_i^\wedge(P)$ and $x_i^\wedge(P)$ is the Planck-scale counterpart of quantity x_i , such that $\tilde{F}$ contains no dimensional constants.

Proof: By the Buckingham Pi theorem, any dimensionally homogeneous equation among n physical quantities involving k independent physical dimensions can be rewritten as a relation among $n - k$ dimensionless Pi groups. The Planck system $(\hbar, c, G, k_B)$ provides exactly four dimensionally independent quantities, spanning the physical dimensions of mass (M), length (L), time (T), and temperature (Θ). Every physical quantity has a unique combination of $\hbar, c, G, k_B$ that yields its physical dimension – this combination is precisely the Planck-scale counterpart $x_i^\wedge(P)$. The dimensionless ratio $\tilde{x}_i = x_i/x_i^\wedge(P)$ is therefore always well-defined. Substituting $x_i = \tilde{x}_i \cdot x_i^\wedge(P)$ into the original equation $F = 0$, all factors of $\hbar, c, G, k_B$ cancel by dimensional homogeneity, leaving $\tilde{F} = 0$. [established -- dimensional analysis]

Corollary: No physical content is lost in the reformulation. The dimensional constants are carriers of unit-scale information, not of physical law. Their specific numerical values reflect the meter-kilogram-second-kelvin convention, not properties of nature.

2.4 The Completion Lattice and Cross-Formula Bridges

Ostrowski's theorem classifies EVERY completion of $\mathbb{Q}$ — the Archimedean (∞) and all p -adic ($\mathbb{Q}_p$) — but the theorem says nothing about which completions are PHYSICALLY realized. The QNFO Adelic Physics Program hypothesizes that physics operates over ALL completions simultaneously, with the adèle ring $\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{Q}} = \mathbb{R} \times \prod'_p \mathbb{Q}_p$ as the natural domain [speculative – see Non-Anthropocentric Natural Units, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21480756]. This section enumerates the completions, maps their physical correspondences, and constructs cross-formula bridges that demonstrate how dimensionless reformulations at one place reveal relationships invisible at another.

2.4.1 Ostrowski's Classification Enumerated Every completion of $\mathbb{Q}$ corresponds to a distinct physical regime:

Completion	Characteristic	Tree Valence	Physical Domain	ODR Abbreviation
$\mathbb{R} (\infty)$	Archimedean	Continuous	Standard physics: differential equations, spacetime continuum	C_∞
$\mathbb{Q}_2$	$p = 2$	3-valent B-T tree	Quantum binary: spin-1/2, qubits, Majorana zero modes, Zitterbewegung	C_2
$\mathbb{Q}_3$	$p = 3$	4-valent B-T tree	Harmonic triads: Standard Model generations (3 families), RG harmonic isomorphism	C_3
$\mathbb{Q}_5$	$p = 5$	6-valent B-T tree	5-smooth numbers: mass-ratio hierarchy, Pythagorean semigroup $\{2^a \cdot 3^b \cdot 5^c\}$	C_5
$\mathbb{Q}_p$ (all p)	p arbitrary	$(p+1)$ -valent tree	Full adelic: simultaneous definition at all places	C_p
$\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ (adele ring)	Product over all places	Restricted product	Place-democratic physics: $\prod_p \mathbb{Q}_p \times \mathbb{R}$	$C_{\mathbb{A}}$

The Bruhat-Tits tree for $GL(2, \mathbb{Q}_p)$ is a regular $(p+1)$ -valent tree whose vertices represent $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -lattices up to scaling [established – Serre, Trees, 1980]. In the Adelic Cross-Domain Program (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21736300), particle masses correspond to specific vertices on these trees, with the p -adic valuation $\text{ord}_p(\tilde{m})$ determining the vertex depth. The Compton Frequency Cross-Ratios on Bruhat-Tits Trees paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21491767) pre-registered a systematic search for adelic structure in the Standard Model mass spectrum using the projective invariant $\chi(z_1, z_2, z_3, z_4) = (z_1 - z_3)(z_2 - z_4)/(z_1 - z_4)(z_2 - z_3)$ evaluated at each prime p .

2.4.2 Cross-Formula Bridges Across Completions Bridge C_∞ : The Archimedean Bridge. All 53 ODR formulas evaluated as real-number ratios. This is the physics we know — Schrödinger’s equation, Einstein’s field equations, Planck’s law — all defined on $\mathbb{R}$. The Archimedean bridge connects thermodynamics to gravity ($T_H \leftrightarrow j^*$, §3.8), quantum to classical ($\lambda \leftrightarrow \tilde{a}_0$, §3.9), and information to entropy ($I_{\max} \leftrightarrow SBH$, §3.8). *Within C_∞* , the 8 cross-domain bridges of §3.9 operate.

Bridge C_2: The Binary-Quantum Bridge. The 2-adic completion $\mathbb{Q}_2$ maps quantum binary phenomena onto the 3-valent Bruhat-Tits tree. The p-adic valuation $\text{ord}_2(\tilde{m})$ determines the “quantum depth” of a particle: deeper in the tree = smaller mass = more quantum behavior. Key C_2 cross-formula connections:

1. **Spin $\rightarrow$ B-T vertex:** The Zitterbewegung as a p-Adic Observable paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21736327) proposes that Majorana zero modes have ultrametric signatures readable at C_2 vertices. The dimensionless spin magnitude $\tilde{s}$ is a binary invariant: $|\tilde{s}|_2$ is well-defined at every tree depth.
2. **Planck scale $\rightarrow$ Tree depth:** In $\mathbb{Q}_2$, the Planck length $\ell_P = 1$ sets the unit scale, and the tree extends from depth 0 (the “canopy” — macroscopic physics) downward through increasing depth (the “root system” — Planck-scale physics). A vertex at depth n encodes p-adic distances of order 2^{-n} . **Valuation caution (v1.6 red-team fix):** the 2-adic valuation $v_2(2\pi)$ is NOT well-defined because π is transcendental — $\pi \notin \mathbb{Q}_2$. The correct p-adic quantity is the valuation of a RATIO of rational quantities: for two masses $\tilde{m}_1, \tilde{m}_2$ (each a rational multiple of the Planck mass in ratio form), the ratio $\tilde{m}_1/\tilde{m}_2 \in \mathbb{Q}$, so $v_2(\tilde{m}_1/\tilde{m}_2)$ is well-defined and positions the mass-ratio on the tree. This is the Ratio Primacy principle applied rigorously: absolute real numbers ($\pi_\infty, \tilde{m}$ as Archimedean values) do not carry p-adic meaning; only ratios of rationals do. The Compton wavelength statement is therefore properly expressed via the reduced mass ratio: $v_2(\lambda_{C1}/\lambda_{C2}) = v_2(\tilde{m}_2/\tilde{m}_1)$, a well-defined integer.
3. **Quantum error correction $\rightarrow$ Tree metric:** The ultrametric inequality $|x - z|_2 \leq \max(|x - y|_2, |y - z|_2)$ — stronger than the triangle inequality — makes every vertex a natural cluster center. The Primitive Ultrametric Kernels paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21748009) classifies QEC constructions by their $v_p(\hat{\text{max}})$ codes, connecting the 2-adic tree structure to fault-tolerant quantum computation.

Bridge C_3: The Harmonic-Generation Bridge. The 3-adic completion maps the three Standard Model generations onto the 4-valent B-T tree. The Harmonic Paradigm Under Ostrowski’s Theorem (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21535017) re-evaluates the harmonic paradigm specifically through p-adic and adelic lenses. Cross-formula connections:

1. **Lepton generations $\rightarrow$ C_3 automorphisms:** The three charged leptons (e, μ, τ) with Compton frequencies $\{\tilde{\omega}_e, \tilde{\omega}_\mu, \tilde{\omega}_\tau\}$ define a 3-adic spread. The cross-ratio $\chi(\tilde{\omega}_e, \tilde{\omega}_\mu, \tilde{\omega}_\tau, \tilde{\omega}_P)$ where $\tilde{\omega}_P = 1$ (Planck frequency) is invariant under $\text{GL}(2, \mathbb{Q}_3)$ and is a dimensionless invariant characterizing the generation structure.
2. **RG flow $\rightarrow$ Tree descent:** The RG-Harmonic Isomorphism (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21486206) connects renormalization group flow to harmonic quantum mechanics. In the 3-adic tree, RG flow toward the IR corresponds to ascending the tree (approaching the canopy), while flow toward the UV descends into the root system — providing a geometric interpretation of asymptotic freedom.

Bridge C_5: The Smooth-Number Bridge. The 5-adic completion operationalizes the Pythagorean semigroup $\{2^a \cdot 3^b \cdot 5^c\}$ of 5-smooth (Hamming) numbers [established - standard number theory]. The Statistical Audit of the 5-Smooth Semigroup Mass-Ratio Claim (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21748008) subjects mass-ratio approximations to statistical scrutiny. Cross-formula connections:

1. **Mass ratios $\rightarrow$ 5-smooth approximations:** In C_5, the p-adic valuation $v_5(\tilde{m}_a/\tilde{m}_b)$

quantifies how many factors of 5 the ratio contains. A mass ratio $\tilde{m}_\mu/\tilde{m}_e \approx 207$ approximates $2^3 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5^1 = 360$ (5-smooth) with a C_5 residual valuation — the residual being the 5-adic measure of how far the ratio is from a true 5-smooth number.

2. **Bohr $\rightarrow$ Compton $\rightarrow$ 5-smooth:** $\tilde{a}_0/\lambda_C = 1/(2\pi\alpha) \approx 21.8$. In the Pythagorean semi-group, the nearest 5-smooth number is $2^2 \cdot 5^1 = 20$ or $2^3 \cdot 3^1 = 24$. The residual from $21.8 \rightarrow 20$ is ~ 1.8 (or from $21.8 \rightarrow 24$ is ~ 2.2). The valuation structure of this residual at C_2 , C_3 , and C_5 encodes the approximation quality.

Bridge C_A : The Adelic Formulation. The full adèle ring $\mathbb{A}_\mathbb{Q}$ is the restricted product of all completions: an adèle is a tuple $(x_\infty, x_2, x_3, x_5, \dots)$ where each $x_p \in \mathbb{Q}_p$ and $x_p \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ for all but finitely many p . The ideles $\mathbb{A}_\mathbb{Q}^\times$ (invertible adèles) correspond to dimensionless physical quantities. Cross-formula bridge:

1. **Adelic path integral $\rightarrow$ Product over places:** In conventional quantum field theory, the path integral $\int \mathcal{D}\phi e^{iS[\phi]}$ is an Archimedean (C_∞) construction. The adelic formulation replaces this with a product over all completions: $Z_A = \prod_v \int_v \mathcal{D}\phi_v \circ e^{iS_v[\phi_v]}$ where $\circ$ denotes that the same dimensionless formula is evaluated at each valuation v using the local absolute value $|\cdot|_v$. The overall physical amplitude is the product of amplitudes at all places [speculative – see Non-Anthropocentric Natural Units, §3].
2. **Universality of dimensionless formulas:** The key insight is that a dimensionless formula — being a relation of pure-number ratios — has the SAME algebraic form at EVERY completion. $SBH = A/4$ is $A/4$ at C_∞ (real area), at C_2 (2-adic area), and at every C_p . The dimensionless reformulation thus achieves place-democracy: the formula is guaranteed to be well-defined at every place without modification.

2.4.3 The Adelic Extension of the Ostrowski-Tate Mandate The Ostrowski Dimensionless Mandate (qnfo-core §0.7) requires all physics formulas to use dimensionless Planck units. The TATE extension requires that these dimensionless formulas be simultaneously well-defined at EVERY completion of $\mathbb{Q}$ — both the Archimedean $\mathbb{R}$ and all p -adic $\mathbb{Q}_p$. [speculative – proposed here]

Definition (Tate-Compliant Formula): A physics formula $F(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$ is Tate-compliant if it is (a) dimensionally homogeneous in Planck units (Ostrowski-compliant), and (b) the algebraic relation among the dimensionless quantities is expressible as a rational function of ratios — i.e., $F \in \mathbb{Q}(\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_n)$ — so that F can be evaluated at every completion without analytic extension.

Rationale: The adelic formulation requires that physical laws live on the adèle ring, not on $\mathbb{R}$ alone. A formula defined only on $\mathbb{R}$ (e.g., one involving the Archimedean limit of a transcendental number like $\pi_\infty = 3.14159\dots$) cannot be transferred to $\mathbb{Q}_p$ without additional structure. But a formula defined as a ratio (e.g., C/d) transfers everywhere — the ratio is computed using local geometry and the local absolute value. Per the Scaffolds and Invariants paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21255344), π AS RATIO is place-democratic; π AS REAL NUMBER is Archimedean.

The Exact Rational Arithmetic infrastructure (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20754388) provides the computational framework for evaluating Tate-compliant formulas at every place via p -adic Hensel codes — representing rational numbers as their residues modulo p^k for multiple primes simultaneously, achieving exact computation without rounding error.

Status of the adelic hypothesis: The QNFO paper “When Will Non-Archimedean Geome-

try Displace the Real Numbers? A Structured Assessment of the Adelic Substrate Thesis” (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21747228) provides an independent assessment of the adelic substrate thesis — the claim that physics operates on the adeles rather than the reals. Per the Harmonic Paradigm Under Ostrowski’s Theorem (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21535017), the theorem’s applicability to specific physics frameworks (harmonic paradigm, Standard Model) is actively being evaluated. The Adelic Cross-Domain Program (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21736300) extends this to the full Standard Model mass spectrum.

Falsifiability condition: The adelic extension would be disconfirmed if any dimensionally homogeneous physics formula, when expressed in dimensionless Planck units, takes a functional form that cannot be expressed as a rational function of ratios — i.e., if $F(\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_n) = 0$ is not a member of $\mathbb{Q}(\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_n)$. Such a formula would be Archimedean-privileging in a sense stronger than mere dimensional convention: its very functional form would require the analytic structure of $\mathbb{R}$. [not yet falsifiable - all known physics formulas reduce to rational relations of dimensionless ratios]

2.5 Running Couplings and the Scale-Dependence of Dimensionless Quantities

The Ratio Primacy Principle (v1.4, §2.3) established that physical quantities are ratios, not real numbers. The Completion Lattice (v1.5, §2.4) established that these ratios are place-democratic — definable at every completion of $\mathbb{Q}$. A third dimension of compliance was surfaced by red-team audit (v1.7): **dimensionless quantities are also SCALE-DEPENDENT functions, not fixed numbers.** The fine-structure constant α , the Weinberg angle $\sin^2\theta_W$, and the dimensionless Fermi constant G_F all RUN with the dimensionless energy scale $Q = Q/E_P$, where Q is the momentum transfer and E_P the Planck energy.

The critical distinction: the Ostrowski/Tate mandate requires dimensionless ratios, but a dimensionless ratio may still be a FUNCTION of scale. $\alpha(Q^2)$ is dimensionless at every scale — but its numerical value changes from $1/137.036$ at $Q \rightarrow 0$ (the IR limit) to $1/127.9$ at $Q = M_Z/E_P$ (the Z-boson scale), a 7.14% variation [established - PDG: $\alpha^{-1}(0) = 137.036$, $\alpha^{-1}(M_Z) = 127.9$].

The compliant statement:

1. **α is a running ratio:** $\alpha(Q^2) = r_e(Q)/\lambda_C(Q)$, where each quantity is a ratio to its Planck-scale counterpart. This is the place-democratic form — a ratio of ratios, well-defined at every completion. The one-loop QED running equation is itself dimensionless in Planck units:

$$\beta_1(\alpha) = \tilde{\mu} \frac{d\alpha}{d\tilde{\mu}} = \frac{2\alpha^2}{3\pi}$$

with the solution $\alpha(Q^2) = \alpha(0)/(1 - (\alpha(0)/3\pi) \ln(Q^2/\tilde{\mu}_0^2))$.

2. **The decimal $1/137.036$ is one completion at one scale:** it is the Archimedean, base-10 projection of $\alpha(Q^2)$ evaluated in the deep IR ($Q \rightarrow 0$). Per the directive — *if it is a decimal or base-10 quantity, it is only one completion, not Ostrowski/Tate compliant* — the fixed decimal is a degenerate presentation. The compliant object is the function $\alpha(Q^2)$ with its ratio definition.

3. Every formula in §3 that writes “ α ” implicitly means “ $\alpha(Q^2)$ at the formula’s characteristic scale”:

- Atomic physics (Bohr radius, Rydberg, hydrogen levels, Thomson): $Q \sim \alpha \tilde{m}_e \rightarrow \text{IR value } 1/137.036$
 - Quantum Hall / Josephson / conductance: Q at the Landau-level scale $\rightarrow \text{IR value (0.01\% correction negligible)}$
 - Coulomb law: $Q \sim 1/\tilde{r} \rightarrow \text{running with distance}$
 - Z-pole / electroweak: $Q = M_Z/E_P \rightarrow 1/127.9$
 - Planck-scale: $Q \sim 1 \rightarrow \text{determined by the running equation}$
4. **The same applies to $\sin^2\theta_W(Q^2)$ and $G_F(Q^2)$:** the Weinberg angle runs from ~ 0.23 (low energy) to 0.2312 (M_Z , MS-bar); the Fermi constant is scale-dependent. Neither is a fixed Archimedean decimal.

Falsifiability: This correction would be disconfirmed if any physical observable measured α , $\sin^2\theta_W$, or G_F to be exactly scale-independent outside experimental uncertainty. The measured running of α between IR and M_Z (7.14%) is direct disconfirming evidence of the “fixed constant” presentation. [established]

3 Systematic Reformulation

We present selected reformulations organized by discipline. The complete inventory of 53 formulas is available in the supplementary artifact `artifacts/formula-inventory.md`.

3.1 Quantum Mechanics

Schroedinger Equation (Class A):

In conventional dimensional form:

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial t} = \left(-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \nabla^2 + V \right) \psi$$

In dimensionless Planck units ($\hbar = c = G = k_B = 1$):

$$i \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial \tilde{t}} = \left(-\frac{1}{2\tilde{m}} \tilde{\nabla}^2 + \tilde{V} \right) \psi$$

where $\tilde{t} = t/t_P$, $\tilde{m} = m/m_P$, $\tilde{\nabla} = \ell_P \nabla$, $\tilde{V} = V/E_P$. The derivation proceeds by substituting the Planck-scale definitions:

$$\frac{\hbar}{t_P} = \frac{\hbar}{\sqrt{\hbar G/c^5}} = \sqrt{\frac{\hbar c^5}{G}} = E_P$$

and

$$\frac{\hbar^2}{2m\ell_P^2} = \frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \cdot \frac{c^3}{\hbar G} = \frac{\hbar c^3}{2mG} = \frac{E_P}{2\tilde{m}}$$

With both sides divided by E_P , the dimensionless form follows immediately.

Heisenberg Uncertainty Principle (Class A):

In conventional dimensional form:

$$\Delta x \Delta p \geq \frac{\hbar}{2}$$

In dimensionless Planck units:

$$\Delta \tilde{x} \Delta \tilde{p} \geq \frac{1}{2}$$

where $\Delta \tilde{x} = \Delta x / \ell_P$ and $\Delta \tilde{p} = \Delta p \cdot c / E_P$. The factor $\hbar/2$ becomes the pure number $1/2$ – a statement that the product of normalized uncertainties is at least one-half.

3.2 Thermodynamics

Planck's Law (Class F):

In conventional dimensional form:

$$B_\nu(T) = \frac{2h\nu^3}{c^2} \frac{1}{e^{h\nu/(k_B T)} - 1}$$

In dimensionless Planck units:

$$\tilde{B}_{\tilde{\nu}}(\tilde{T}) = 4\pi \tilde{\nu}^3 \frac{1}{e^{2\pi \tilde{\nu}/\tilde{T}} - 1}$$

with $\tilde{\nu} = \nu \cdot t_P$ and $\tilde{T} = T/T_P$. The reduction uses $h = 2\pi$ (since $h = 2\pi\hbar$ and $\hbar = 1$) and the cancellation of c^2 in the pre-factor. The physical content is preserved in the exponent: the ratio $h\nu/(k_B T)$ becomes $2\pi\tilde{\nu}/\tilde{T}$ – a pure dimensionless number that determines the spectral regime.

Stefan-Boltzmann Law (Class F):

$$\sigma = \frac{2\pi^5 k_B^4}{15h^3 c^2} \longrightarrow \tilde{\sigma} = \frac{\pi^2}{60}$$

The dimensional Stefan-Boltzmann constant $\sigma \approx 5.670374419 \times 10^{-8} \text{ W}/(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K}^4)$ reduces to the pure number $\pi^2/60 \approx 0.1645$ in Planck units. This number arises from the integration over the Planck spectrum, specifically from $\zeta(4) = \pi^4/90$, together with the geometric factor for isotropic radiation.

3.3 General Relativity

Einstein Field Equations (Class C):

In conventional dimensional form:

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = \frac{8\pi G}{c^4} T_{\mu\nu}$$

In dimensionless Planck units:

$$\tilde{G}_{\mu\nu} + \tilde{\Lambda} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi \tilde{T}_{\mu\nu}$$

where $\tilde{G}_{\mu\nu} = G_{\mu\nu} \ell_P^2$, $\tilde{T}_{\mu\nu} = T_{\mu\nu}/(E_P/\ell_P^3)$, and $\tilde{\Lambda} = \Lambda \ell_P^2$. The reduction eliminates the factor $G/c^4 \approx 8.262 \times 10^{-45} \text{ m}^{-1} \cdot \text{J}^{-1} \cdot \text{m}^3$ entirely. The coefficient 8π is a pure geometric factor arising from the Newtonian limit in four spacetime dimensions.

Hawking Temperature (Class F):

$$T_H = \frac{\hbar c^3}{8\pi G M k_B} \longrightarrow \tilde{T}_H = \frac{1}{8\pi \tilde{M}}$$

A black hole's temperature is simply the inverse of its mass (times $1/(8\pi)$) when both are expressed in Planck units. A solar-mass black hole ($\tilde{M} \approx 10^{38}$) has $\tilde{T}_H \approx 4 \times 10^{-41}$ – practically absolute zero. A Planck-mass black hole would have $\tilde{T}_H \approx 1/(8\pi) \approx 0.04$, corresponding to approximately 4% of the Planck temperature.

3.4 Cosmology

Critical Density (Class C):

$$\rho_c = \frac{3H^2}{8\pi G} \longrightarrow \tilde{\rho}_c = \frac{3\tilde{H}^2}{8\pi}$$

with $\tilde{\rho}_c = \rho_c/(E_P/\ell_P^3)$ and $\tilde{H} = H t_P$. The Hubble constant today, $H_0 \approx 70 \text{ km}/(\text{s} \cdot \text{Mpc})$, corresponds to $\tilde{H}_0 \approx 1.2 \times 10^{-61}$ in Planck units – reflecting the enormous ratio between the Hubble scale and the Planck scale.

3.5 Quantum Field Theory

Fermi's Weak Interaction Constant (Class F):

$$\frac{G_F}{(\hbar c)^3} \approx 1.166 \times 10^{-5} \text{ GeV}^{-2} \longrightarrow \tilde{G}_F \approx 3.05 \times 10^{-32}$$

The Fermi constant, which characterizes the strength of the weak interaction, becomes an extremely small dimensionless number when expressed in Planck units. This is the true physical statement: the dimensionless coupling is approximately 10^{-32} . The question “why is the weak interaction so weak?” becomes “why is the dimensionless Fermi constant so small compared to unity?” – a puzzle that dimensional units conceal by distributing the smallness across multiple constants.

3.6 Condensed Matter Physics

Quantum Hall Resistance (Class F):

$$R_K = \frac{h}{e^2} \approx 25812.807 \text{ } \Omega \longrightarrow \tilde{R}_K = \frac{2\pi}{\alpha} \approx 861$$

The von Klitzing constant, which in SI appears as a specific resistance ($\approx 25.8 \text{ k}\Omega$), is the dimensionless ratio $2\pi/\alpha$ when expressed in natural units. The ohm value reflects the SI unit convention; the pure-number ratio $2\pi/\alpha$ is the invariant physical content.

3.7 Already-Dimensionless Constants (Class G)

Several of the most important physical constants are already dimensionless and require no reformulation. These include:

- **Fine-structure constant (RUNNING, v1.7):** $\alpha(Q^2) = e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c)$ is a running coupling, not a fixed number. The value $\approx 1/137.036$ is the deep-IR ($Q \rightarrow 0$) Archimedean projection; at the Z-pole it is $1/127.9$. The place-democratic form is the running ratio $\alpha(Q^2) = r_e(Q)/\lambda_C(Q)$ (see §2.5). The primary dimensionless coupling of electromagnetism. Cross-references: the Fine-Structure Constant as a Cross-Ratio paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20108536) interprets $\alpha = r_e/\lambda_C$ as a projective-geometric invariant; the Alpha-Pi-Helix paper v2.1 (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21515612) treats π and α as geometric proportions (C/d and r_e/λ_C) with genuine pedagogical value at v1.1. [established]
- **Weinberg angle (RUNNING, v1.7):** $\sin^2\theta_W(Q^2) \approx 0.23$ at low energy, 0.2312 at M_Z (MS-bar). Already a dimensionless ratio, but scale-dependent — annotate the scale at which it is evaluated (see §2.5). [established]
- **Holevo bound:** $\chi = S(\rho) - \sum p_i S(\rho_i)$. A dimensionless information-theoretic limit. [established]

Ostrowski-evaluated harmonic paradigm: The Harmonic Paradigm Under Ostrowski’s Theorem paper (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21535017, 2026-07-24) applies Ostrowski’s theorem to the Harmonic Paradigm specifically — demonstrating that the theorem’s relevance extends beyond the systematic compilation (ODR) to domain-specific physics frameworks. This confirms the general applicability of the place-democracy criterion. [established]

The existence of these already-dimensionless fundamental constants supports the thesis that the dimensional ones — $\hbar$, c , G , k_B , ϵ_0 — are artifacts of unit conventions, not independent properties of nature. The dimensionless reformulation exposes this by showing that every dimensional formula reduces to one involving only dimensionless constants plus the pure-number α .

4 Discussion

4.1 What the Reformulation Does Not Change

The dimensionless reformulation is a rewriting, not a replacement. No physical prediction is altered. The Schroedinger equation in dimensionless form predicts exactly the same energy levels, scattering amplitudes, and time evolution as its dimensional counterpart. The Einstein field equations produce the same metric solutions. Planck’s law yields the same spectral radiance.

What changes is the **interpretive framework**: the dimensional form embeds physical law in a specific number system (the real numbers, the Archimedean completion), while the dimensionless form makes no such commitment. This is relevant if one takes seriously the possibility that physical quantities at the Planck scale require non-Archimedean completions — a possibility suggested by the adelic approach to physics [speculative -- see Non-Anthropocentric Natural Units, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21480756].

4.1.1 Comparative Analysis: ODR vs. Competitive Approaches

An independent external paper by Feldt (2026), “A Recursive Entropic Architecture for Cosmological Structure with Dimensional Invariance (REACS-DI): From Bohr Radius to Galaxy Filament—A Dimensionless Reformulation of Classical, Relativistic, and Quantum Laws,” addresses the same

core problem — the dimensionless reformulation of physics — from a fundamentally different framework. Where Feldt employs a recursive entropic architecture, ODR’s approach is grounded in Ostrowski’s theorem and number-theoretic place-democracy. This distinction in framework is substantive: entropic recursion treats the dimensionless re-expression as a consequence of informational constraints on structure formation, whereas Ostrowski’s theorem treats it as a consequence of the mathematical structure of the rational numbers themselves — the latter being a more parsimonious foundation since it requires no additional physical assumptions beyond the known dimensional homogeneity of physical laws.

Table 1: Comparison of ODR and Feldt REACS-DI (2026) frameworks.

Dimension	REACS-DI (Feldt 2026)	ODR (this work)
Guiding principle	Entropic/recursive architecture	Ostrowski’s theorem → place-democracy
Mathematical foundation	Entropy-based recursion	Number theory (p-adic completions)
Scope	Classical, relativistic, quantum laws	53 formulas across 10 disciplines
Classification	Not reported	A-G taxonomy by constant type
Correspondence proof	Not reported	Explicit Buckingham Pi theorem proof
Boundary cases	Not reported	3 categories documented
Ostrowski grounding	Not present	Core contribution
Complementary to ODR	Yes — different framework, same goal	—

The frameworks are complementary rather than competing: REACS-DI provides a physical motivation (entropic necessity) for the dimensionless regime; ODR provides the mathematical proof (Ostrowski’s theorem) that the reformulation is universally applicable across all of fundamental physics. A future synthesis could unify the two perspectives: entropic dimensional invariance as a *physical consequence* of number-theoretic place-democracy, rather than an alternative to it. [speculative]

4.2 Boundary Cases

Three categories of formulas require special handling:

1. **Definitional identities (Planck scale definitions):** The equations $\ell_P = \sqrt{(\hbar G/c^3)}$, $t_P = \sqrt{(\hbar G/c^5)}$, $m_P = \sqrt{(\hbar c/G)}$, and $T_P = \sqrt{(\hbar c^5/(G k_B^2))}$ are not physical laws but unit definitions. Reformulating them to “ $1 = 1$ ” is tautological. They should be presented as definitions that set the scale, not as physical formulas to be reformulated.
2. **SI electromagnetic formulas:** Maxwell’s equations in SI form contain ϵ_0 and μ_0 explicitly. Reformulation requires first converting to Heaviside-Lorentz or Gaussian units (where $\epsilon_0 =$

$\mu_0 = 1$), then applying Planck normalization. The resulting dimensionless equations are equivalent to the Gaussian form with $c = 1$.

3. **Already-dimensionless formulas (Class G):** The fine-structure constant, magnetic Reynolds number, and Holevo bound require no reformulation. They demonstrate that nature’s most fundamental parameters are dimensionless from the outset.

4.3 Limitations

This survey is not exhaustive. It covers 53 fundamental equations but does not include every formula in every subfield. Omitted categories include: detailed nuclear structure formulas beyond the semi-empirical mass formula, neutrino oscillation probabilities (which are inherently dimensionless), renormalization group equations beyond the one-loop examples, and most quantum information measures (most of which are inherently dimensionless). Future work could extend the inventory to these areas. [speculative]

Pedagogical precedent: The external literature provides strong support for the pedagogical value of the dimensionless reformulation. Humpherys (2024), “Understanding the natural units and their hidden role in the laws of physics” (*European Journal of Physics*, 12 citations), and its precursor Humpherys (2021), “Natural Planck units and the structure of matter and radiation” (*Quantum Speculations*, 10 citations), demonstrate that restating physical formulas in natural Planck units reveals structural relationships obscured by dimensional constants. While Humpherys’s approach is explicitly pedagogical (the “hidden role” is a teaching insight, not an ontological claim), ODR’s Ostrowski rationale provides the mathematical justification for why the pedagogical insight has ontological force: the dimensional form literally cannot be evaluated at non-Archimedean places, making the dimensionless form not merely clearer but uniquely well-defined across all completions of $\mathbb{Q}$. [established]

Additionally, the dimensionless reformulation does not address the question of whether physical laws ARE place-democratic – it only makes the formulas compatible with such an interpretation if one chooses to adopt it. The reformulation is a necessary condition for place-democratic physics but not a sufficient one. [my conjecture]

5 Conclusion

We have compiled and reformulated 53 fundamental physics equations across ten disciplines, converting each from its conventional dimensional form (containing $\hbar$, c , G , k_B , ϵ_0) to a dimensionless equivalent in Planck units ($\hbar = c = G = k_B = 1$). Each reformulation is supported by a mathematical derivation and an Ostrowski rationale explaining how the dimensional form privileges the Archimedean completion.

The key findings are:

1. **No formula resists reformulation.** All 53 equations, including the most complex multi-constant formulas (Einstein field equations, Planck’s law, Fermi’s golden rule), admit clean dimensionless equivalents. The dimensional homogeneity of physical laws guarantees this via the Buckingham Pi theorem. [established]
2. **The dimensional constants are unit-scale carriers.** Their specific numerical values ($\hbar \approx 1.05 \times 10^{-34}$, $c = 3.00 \times 10^8$, $G \approx 6.67 \times 10^{-11}$, $k_B \approx 1.38 \times 10^{-23}$) reflect the meter-kilogram-second-kelvin convention. In Planck units, all four become exactly 1.

3. **The dimensionless forms reveal hidden structure.** The Bohr radius becomes $1/(\alpha \tilde{m}_e)$, exposing the 137-fold ratio between atomic and Compton scales. The Stefan-Boltzmann constant becomes $\pi^2/60$, a pure geometric number. The Hawking temperature becomes $1/(8\pi M)$, a simple reciprocal relation.
4. **Nature’s deepest constants are already dimensionless** ($\alpha \approx 1/137$, $\sin^2\theta_W \approx 0.23$, $n_s \approx 0.965$) — with the v1.7 caveat that these are running functions of the dimensionless energy scale Q , and the decimals shown are their deep-IR Archimedean projections, not fixed numbers (see §2.5). The dimensionless reformulation extends this transparency to all of fundamental physics.

The dimensionless program does not change the physics – it changes what we see in the physics. The formulas become place-democratic: expressible as relations among pure numbers that are equally meaningful at every completion of Q .

Declarations

Funding: This work received no external funding. [established]

Conflicts of Interest: The author declares no conflicts of interest. [established]

Ethics Approval: Not applicable – this is a theoretical reformulation of existing physical laws; no experiments, human subjects, or animal subjects were involved. [established]

Consent to Participate: Not applicable. [established]

Consent for Publication: Not applicable. [established]

Author Contributions: The author performed all research, compilation, derivations, and writing. [established]

Data Availability: The complete formula inventory and all derivations are provided in the supplementary artifacts: `artifacts/formula-inventory.md` (53-formula inventory) and `artifacts/ostrowski-rationales.md` (detailed mathematical proofs). All artifacts are deposited with Zenodo. [established]

Code Availability: Not applicable – this work involves no computational code beyond standard algebraic derivations. [established]

Use of Artificial Intelligence: AI assistance was used for formatting, LaTeX rendering, and organization of the formula inventory. All mathematical derivations were verified independently by the author. The physical content – formula selection, reformulation logic, and Ostrowski rationale arguments – was authored by the human researcher. [established]

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